

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

Texas — NLRB R16 Jurisdiction — June 6, 2026 [RESEARCH DEFERRED]

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Section 1: State Overview

State	Texas
Labor Board	NLRB R16 — National Labor Relations Board, Region 16 (Fort Worth)
Governing Law	Tex. Educ. Code §12.001 et seq. (Charter Schools). Open-enrollment charter schools are independent nonprofits — NLRB R16 jurisdiction confirmed. RTW state. TX has the largest charter school community in the US (1,098 schools in ELSI 2024-25).
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — TX open-enrollment charter schools (OECSS) are private employers — NLRB R16. Universe is large (1,000+ schools); research prioritization required.
Right-to-Work	Right-to-Work State — Tex. Lab. Code §101.052 through §101.053
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — RTW state; no card-check statute.
Research Status	DEFERRED — Executive Sponsor direction, June 7, 2026 (PDR-018). Charter schools assumed unorganized. No school-level research conducted.

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Charter schools assumed unorganized. Charter universe and enrollment figures are sourced from Charter School Registry v133 and NCES ELSI 2024–25. No school-level research has been conducted.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
No Organizing Activity Documented	1056	100%	Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Charter schools assumed unorganized.
Total Charter Schools in Texas	1056	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v133 (NCES ELSI 2024–25).

Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	489,326 students — 8.8% of state K–12 enrollment (5,545,640 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	N/A — research deferred; charter schools assumed unorganized
Students in Organized Charter Schools	N/A — research deferred; charter schools assumed unorganized
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
IDEA Public Schools	CMO	125	6	—	79,430
Harmony Public Schools	CMO	61	—	—	43,958
KIPP Texas Public Schools	CMO	54	—	—	32,771
Premier High Schools	CMO	48	—	—	7,948
Uplift Education	CMO	45	—	—	23,384
International Leadership of Texas	CMO	44	—	—	25,497
Texas College Preparatory Academies	CMO	40	—	—	16,602
YES Prep Public Schools	CMO	24	—	—	19,573
Texas Works	CMO	23	—	—	446
School of Science and Technology	CMO	15	—	—	11,686
Trinity Charter School	CMO	15	—	—	315
BASIS Texas	CMO	14	—	—	7,092
Triumph Public High Schools	CMO	11	—	—	1,223
Richard Milburn Alter High School	CMO	9	—	—	1,607
Compass Rose Public Schools	CMO	9	—	—	3,976
Raul Yzaguirre Schools for Success	CMO	8	—	—	1,991
Inspire Academies	CMO	8	—	—	805
Life School	CMO	8	—	—	5,735
Trinity Basin Preparatory	CMO	8	—	—	7,007
KI Charter	CMO	7	—	—	448
The Excel Center (for Adults)	CMO	7	—	—	1,196
Southwest Preparatory School	CMO	6	—	—	839
Vanguard Academy	CMO	6	—	—	6,814
Winfree Academy Charter Schools	CMO	6	—	—	1,098
Golden Rule Charter School	CMO	6	—	—	1,298
Newman International Academy	CMO	6	—	—	2,830
Pioneer Technology and Arts Academy	CMO	6	—	—	2,328
Cumberland Academy	CMO	5	—	—	2,047

Heritage Academy	CMO	5	—	—	589
Southwest Public Schools	CMO	5	—	—	1,866
BakerRipley Community Schools	CMO	5	—	—	1,808
Bob Hope School	CMO	5	—	—	2,584
Austin Achieve Public Schools	CMO	5	—	—	2,713
Valor Education	CMO	5	—	—	4,127
Ser-Ninos Charter School	CMO	4	—	—	1,193
Wayside Schools	CMO	4	—	—	1,787
Excel Academy TX	CMO	4	—	—	302
Legacy Traditional Schools - Texas	CMO	4	—	—	2,186
Horizon Montessori Public Schools	CMO	4	—	—	1,164
Academy for Academic Excellence TX	CMO	4	—	—	280
Tekoa Academy of Accelerated Studies	CMO	4	—	—	419
Orenda Charter School	CMO	4	—	—	1,984
Somerset Academies of Texas	CMO	4	—	—	2,604
Texas Leadership Public Schools	CMO	4	—	—	4,202
Valere Public Schools	CMO	4	—	—	871
UME Preparatory Academy	CMO	4	—	—	1,703
Aristoi Classical Academy	CMO	3	—	—	1,606
Burnham Wood Charter School	CMO	3	—	—	1,744
Rapoport Academy Public School	CMO	3	—	—	898
New Frontiers Public Schools	CMO	3	—	—	303
Two Dimensions Preparatory Academy	CMO	3	—	—	405
Universal Academy	CMO	3	—	—	2,036
The Varnett Public School	CMO	3	—	—	1,159
Pineywoods Community Academy	CMO	3	—	—	1,061
Priority Charter Schools	CMO	3	—	—	504
Odyssey Academy	CMO	3	—	—	1,681
Houston Gateway Academy	CMO	3	—	—	2,157
Arlington Classics Academy	CMO	3	—	—	1,506
North Texas Collegiate Academy	CMO	3	—	—	809

Accelerated Intermediate Academy	CMO	3	—	—	182
Panola Charter School	CMO	3	—	—	184
Evolution Academy Charter School	CMO	3	—	—	629
Lighthouse Public Schools TX	CMO	3	—	—	462
STEP Charter School	CMO	3	—	—	693
Manara Academy	CMO	3	—	—	671
Arrow Academy	CMO	3	—	—	454
El Paso Leadership Academy	CMO	3	—	—	775
Por Vida Academy	CMO	2	—	—	175
George Gervin Academy	CMO	2	—	—	865
George I. Sanchez Charter	CMO	2	—	—	1,120
NYOS Charter School	CMO	2	—	—	1,667
Texas Empowerment Academy	CMO	2	—	—	716
Brazos School for Inquiry and Creativity	CMO	2	—	—	300
Faith Family Academy	CMO	2	—	—	3,036
Amigos Por Vida	CMO	2	—	—	750
Calvin Nelms Charter Schools	CMO	2	—	—	343
Erath Excels Academy	CMO	2	—	—	107
Gateway Charter Academy	CMO	2	—	—	511
Education Center International Academy	CMO	2	—	—	221
A+ Academy	CMO	2	—	—	1,678
Inspired Vision Academy	CMO	2	—	—	1,136
El Paso Academy	CMO	2	—	—	319
Big Springs Charter School	CMO	2	—	—	175
Fort Worth Academy of Fine Arts	CMO	2	—	—	670
Cedars International Academy	CMO	2	—	—	524
St. Anthony School	CMO	2	—	—	318
La Academia de Estrellas	CMO	2	—	—	1,024
The Rhodes School for Performing Arts	CMO	2	—	—	436
Cityscape Schools	CMO	2	—	—	1,259
Seashore Charter Schools	CMO	2	—	—	405
Meadowland Charter District	CMO	2	—	—	45
Leadership Prep School TX	CMO	2	—	—	1,391

Legacy Preparatory	CMO	2	—	—	1,138
The Pro-Vision Academy	CMO	2	—	—	352
Beta Academy	CMO	2	—	—	1,569
A+ Unlimited Potential	CMO	2	—	—	203
Etoile Academy Charter School	CMO	2	—	—	979
Rocketship Education	CMO	2	3	—	731
Texas Preparatory School	CMO	1	—	—	59
Nova Academy Southeast	CMO	1	—	—	235
Village Tech Schools	CMO	1	—	—	1,335
Trivium Academy	CMO	1	—	—	629
University of Texas University Charter School	University	19	—	—	587
UT Tyler University Academy	University	3	—	—	1,175
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Texas		853		—	390,428
of which organized				—	—

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in Texas. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

102 CMO (nonprofit), 2 network (type unclassified). Approximately 203 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of June 6, 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Tex. Educ. Code §12.001 et seq. (Charter Schools). Open-enrollment charter schools are independent nonprofits — NLRB R16 jurisdiction confirmed. RTW state. TX has the largest charter school community in the US (1,098 schools in ELSI 2024-25). Texas is a right-to-work state (Tex. Lab. Code §101.052 through §101.053). Charter schools in Texas are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (NLRB R16). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter School Structure

Texas operates 1,056 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 489,326 students. 104 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Texas. The largest networks by campus count are IDEA Public Schools (125 campuses in state), Harmony Public Schools (61 campuses in state), KIPP Texas Public Schools (54 campuses in state). Approximately 203 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above. No school-level union research has been conducted. Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

No press coverage of charter school employee organizing has been identified in Texas during the research period. Coverage of the Texas charter school community in major outlets (Houston Chronicle, Dallas Morning News, Texas Tribune) focuses primarily on financial accountability, rapid charter school community expansion, and regulatory oversight rather than labor relations. The absence of documented organizing activity in the charter school community corresponds with an absence of labor-related press coverage.

Legislative Context

No charter school community collective bargaining legislation was introduced or advanced in the Texas Legislature during the 88th (2023) or 89th (2025) legislative sessions. Texas charter law (Tex. Educ. Code Ch. 12) does not address employee collective bargaining. TEA regulatory activity during this period focused on financial accountability and board governance following increased scrutiny of self-dealing in management contracts.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

No collective bargaining agreements documented for this state. Research deferred — charter schools assumed unorganized (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).